

TEACHING

Anyone, anywhere, can learn to restore living soil.



A mentor teaching on working land.

From a first curiosity through to professional practice. Everyone starts with the Foundation Courses. Where you go next depends on whether you want to grow better yourself, or help others do it.

Foundation Courses

The science of the soil food web, the organisms and their roles, and how biological amendments are made and applied. Online, self-paced, about 150 hours, and required before any Advanced Program.

Advanced Programs

Soil Microscopy, BioComplete™ Compost Production, Biological Liquid Amendments and Field Trial, each with its own mentor. All four together are the full path.

Accelerator Workshops

The Advanced Programs worked through as a group on working land, the whole method applied at once. Held periodically, and hosted with a partner on their land. Dates and places are listed with the programs.

Where it leads

All four Advanced Programs together carry the Soil Food Web Consultant title; Soil Microscopy alone, the Lab Technician title. Every program, with its price, is listed at school.soilfoodweb.com



Apply for a scholarship

Scholarships prioritize applicants in under-resourced regions.

sfw.one/brochure-scholarship

OUR STORY

It began with one scientist looking closer.



Dr. Elaine Ingham at the microscope.

Dr. Elaine Ingham pioneered research in soil biology across forty-five years and made her science radically accessible, so that anyone anywhere could learn to restore the soil beneath their feet.

She founded this work; the Foundation was created in 2025 to carry it forward. She passed in February 2026, and the work she started continues through the Foundation, the school inside it, and practitioners in more than 132 countries who bring the same close attention to their own soil.

She taught at Oregon State from 1986 to 2002, served as the first President of the Soil Ecology Society, and co-authored the USDA's Soil Biology Primer.



Her published record, in full:
scholar.google.com/citations?user=iOm3z4AAAAAJ

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CLIMATE

Plants pull carbon from the air and invest much of it in the soil, where it is built into microbial bodies, aggregates and long-lived fungal networks. Biological management also avoids emissions: less fertilizer manufactured and moved, fewer passes over the field.



Watch a free webinar

A live hour with an instructor or a practitioner, every month. The easiest first step.

sfw.one/brochure-webinar



Soil Food Web Foundation

A 501(c)(3) nonprofit



The ground beneath our farms and forests is alive.

A web of bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes and micro-arthropods feeds plants, builds soil, stores carbon and cleans water when it is intact.

For forty-five years, Dr. Elaine Ingham mapped that web and taught the world to restore it. We carry her work forward: teaching the science to anyone willing to learn, opening the research for the world to test, proving the practice on real land, and growing a global community of Soil Regenerators. Living soil is the solution, and it is beneath your feet.



EDUCATION



RESEARCH



PRACTICE



COMMUNITY

132+

Countries in our student and practitioner community

10,000+

Individuals enrolled in our programs

45

Years of pioneering soil biology research behind the method

Healing soil.
Feeding humanity.
Restoring the living world.